NSRA Title XXXVIII · Family & Workforce Security

Twelve Weeks of Paid Leave, More Child Care, and the Tradespeople America Needs

The United States is the **only OECD country** without a national paid leave entitlement for new parents. Thirteen States and D.C. already run paid leave insurance that works. Title XXXVIII brings that model nationwide, financed by its own small contribution rather than new deficit spending, and pairs it with child care supply and an apprenticeship credit for the jobs this bill creates.

What it does

Provision	Draft text
12 weeks paid leave	For a new child, a serious illness, caring for a sick family member, or a military deployment, matching the FMLA reasons (Sec. 3802(b))
Benefit	66% of wages, 85% for low earners, up to a weekly cap of $1,000–$1,500 (Sec. 3802(d))
How it's paid for	0.2% from workers and 0.2% from employers into a dedicated trust fund, with no employer share for businesses under 10 employees; actuarial solvency certified every three years (Sec. 3802(e))
Respects States and employers	States with equal or better programs keep them; employers with equal or better plans get a contribution credit (Sec. 3802(g)–(h))
Child care supply	Grants to States that add licensed slots, raise provider pay, and streamline licensing for home-based and faith-based providers; employer child care credit raised to $500,000 (Sec. 3803)
Apprenticeships	A $2,500 credit per registered apprentice ($3,500 for veterans, under-25s, or manufacturing zones), refundable for small employers, prioritizing electricians, lineworkers, welders, and technicians (Sec. 3804)

Designed to win votes on both sides

Paid leave is self-financed through insurance, not general revenue. Small businesses pay no employer share. Faith-based and home-based child care compete on equal terms. The apprenticeship credit rewards employers who train workers instead of a new federal program. Child care and apprenticeship costs are capped at $16 billion a year from deficit-neutral SIRF capacity.

Status: discussion draft, not introduced. Operative text: Title XXXVIII (Secs. 3801–3806).

Full text: theamericandeal.org/bill-text · This page: theamericandeal.org/paid-leave · Contact: contact@theamericandeal.org · Fiscal figures are internal models, not CBO or JCT scores. Drafted by Santonio D. Sanders.